

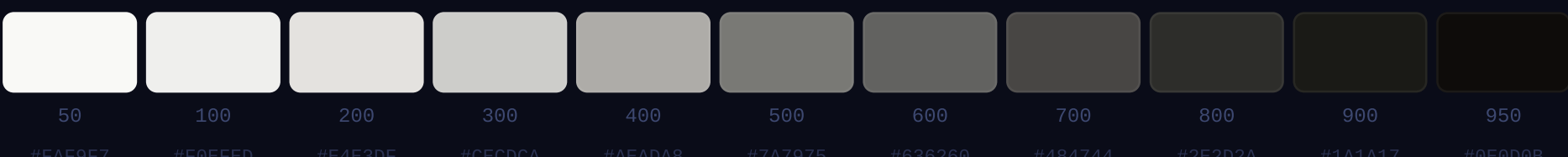
Editorial — Color Foundations

1 · NEUTRALS

Warm-tinted neutral ramp

No pure black (#000000) or pure gray (#808080) anywhere. Every step carries a subtle warm tint (hue ~40°, saturation 3–8%). The light surface scale (50–950) and dark surface scale (950d–50d) reference the same physical ramp at opposite semantic positions.

LIGHT SURFACE SCALE (50 = LIGHTEST)



DARK SURFACE SCALE (950d = DARKEST)



KEY NEUTRAL NOTES — LIGHT

neutral/100 - #F0EFED · Page background (light)
neutral/500 - #7A7975 · Text/subtle — large text only (3.83:1 on bg, headroom above 3:1 floor)
neutral/600 - #6B6260 · Text/muted — body-safe (5.3:1 on light bg)
neutral/700 - #4B4744 · Text/secondary (8.9:1 on light bg)
neutral/900 - #1A1A17 · Page background (dark)
neutral/950 - #0E0D0B · Text/primary light mode (17.3:1 on bg)

KEY NEUTRAL NOTES — DARK

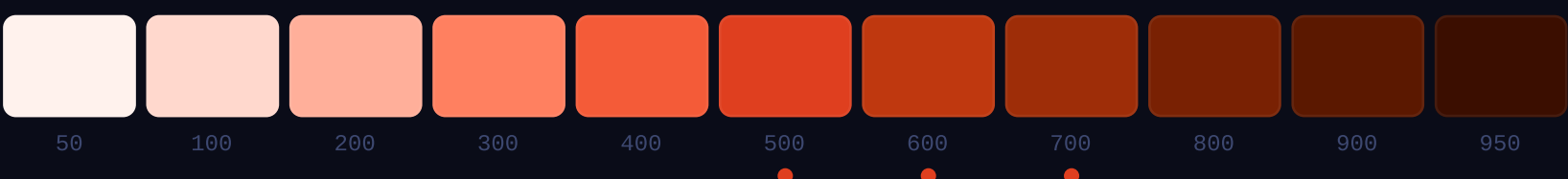
neutral/950d - #0A0A09 · Page background (dark mode)
neutral/900d - #131311 · Surface (dark)
neutral/800d - #1D1D1A · Elevated surface, card (dark)
neutral/700d - #2A2A26 · Muted fill (dark)
neutral/600d - #3A3A35 · Border (dark)
neutral/500d - #4E4D48 · Border strong (dark)

2 · BRAND COLOR RAMPS

Primary, Secondary, Accent, Verified

Four brand ramps. Primary (Vermillion) = action and CTA. Secondary (Warm Steel) = supporting surfaces. Accent (Institutional Blue) = verification context broadly. Verified (Deep Teal) = the proof-trust semantic (Endorsement rows, Contribution entries, verified-skill marks).

COLOR/BRAND/PRIMARY — VERNILLION (~16°)



500 · Dark mode primary button
600 · Light mode primary button · white text 5.1:1 ✓
700 · Hover state (light)

COLOR/BRAND/SECONDARY — WARM STEEL (~220°, DESATURATED)



600 · Secondary surface text

COLOR/BRAND/ACCENT — INSTITUTIONAL BLUE (~220°, SATURATED)



600 · Light mode accent · white text 6.4:1 ✓
700 · Hover

COLOR/BRAND/VERIFIED — DEEP TEAL (~178°) — THE PROOF-TRUST SEMANTIC



600 · Light mode verified mark · white text 6.25:1 ✓ · on bg/page 5.50:1 ✓ — darkened from #087876 for safe margin above 4.5:1 floor
700 · Hover

3 · SEMANTIC COLORS

Success, Warning, Error, Info

All four semantics use hues that don't overlap with brand colors. Error (~0° cool red) is deliberately distinct from the Vermillion primary (~16°) — they must never be confused as the same signal. All contrast ratios verified below.

SUCCESS — GREEN ~150°

color/semantic/success

LIGHT

DARK

Aa

#8AB844

Aa

#14B860

WARNING — AMBER ~38°

color/semantic/warning

LIGHT

DARK

Aa

#C4780B

Aa

#F5A000

ERROR — COOL RED ~0°

color/semantic/error

LIGHT

DARK

Aa

#C41010

Aa

#E83030

INFO — SKY BLUE ~210°

color/semantic/info

LIGHT

DARK

Aa

#80GACE

Aa

#3A94F8

4 · VERIFIED / TRUST SEMANTIC

color/brand/verified — distinct from success

Verified (Deep Teal, ~178°) is the color that marks Endorsement Rows, Contribution Log entries, and verified-skill indicators as proof artifacts — "confirmed by another party," not "operation succeeded." Success green (~150°) is 28° away; Institutional Blue accent (~220°) is 42° away. The hue is wide enough that all three read as categorically different signals.

LIGHT MODE

SKILL TRUST · WITNESSED ENDORSEMENT

TypeScript endorsed by Dr. R. Nair
via ML Grading Pipeline · "Production-grade API design and type safety" · 2d ago

WORK TRUST · CONTRIBUTION LOG

PR

Merged PR #247 · OpenData API v2
a3f8c2d · 14 Sep 2026 · ✓ Verified

verified/600 (#076C6A) · on bg/page: 5.50:1 ✓ · white text on it: 6.25:1 ✓

DARK MODE

SKILL TRUST · WITNESSED ENDORSEMENT

TypeScript endorsed by Dr. R. Nair
via ML Grading Pipeline · "Production-grade API design and type safety" · 2d ago

WORK TRUST · CONTRIBUTION LOG

PR

Merged PR #247 · OpenData API v2
a3f8c2d · 14 Sep 2026 · ✓ Verified

verified/dark (#10C4B8) · on dark bg: 9.1:1 ✓ · dark text on it: 9.1:1 ✓

5 · TIER SYSTEM

Raw → Spark → Flare → Shine → Radiant → Luminary

Color temperature ascends from cool-gray (Raw) through blue (Spark) and violet (Flare) to amber (Shine), orange (Radiant), and deep gold (Luminary). Each tier has a 'color' (dot/icon/border accent) and a 'text' value (text-safe darker shade for chip labels). All text values verified ≥4.5:1 on card surface in both modes. These are CORE tokens.

● Raw (1/6) CORE

Identity verified. No project contributions yet.

LIGHT MODE

● RAW Raw

color: #5E6E84 · text: #3E4E64 · 7.1:1 ✓

DARK MODE

● RAW Raw

color: #9AAEC6 · text: #C0D0E4 · 8.4:1 ✓

● Spark (2/6) CORE

First verified contribution logged.

LIGHT MODE

● SPA Spark

color: #1E60C0 · text: #1E60C0 · 4.6:1 ✓

DARK MODE

● SPA Spark

color: #6298F0 · text: #98C0FF · 6.2:1 ✓

● Flare (3/6) CORE

Active across multiple projects. Endorsements accumulating.

LIGHT MODE

● FLA Flare

color: #5E28CC · text: #5E28CC · 5.6:1 ✓

DARK MODE

● FLA Flare

color: #9C78F0 · text: #BAAAF8 · 5.3:1 ✓

● Shine (4/6) CORE

Consistent output. Recruiter interest. Field-recognized.

LIGHT MODE

● SHI Shine

color: #7A5800 · text: #7A5800 · 5.5:1 ✓

DARK MODE

● SHI Shine

color: #E0B830 · text: #F0D060 · 7.8:1 ✓

● Radiant (5/6) CORE

Top 10% of verified contributors on the platform.

LIGHT MODE

● RAD Radiant

color: #B83808 · text: #B83808 · 6.8:1 ✓

DARK MODE

● RAD Radiant

color: #F07040 · text: #FF8070 · 5.5:1 ✓

● Luminary (6/6) CORE

Exceptional verified record. Industry recognition. The ceiling.

LIGHT MODE

● LUM Luminary

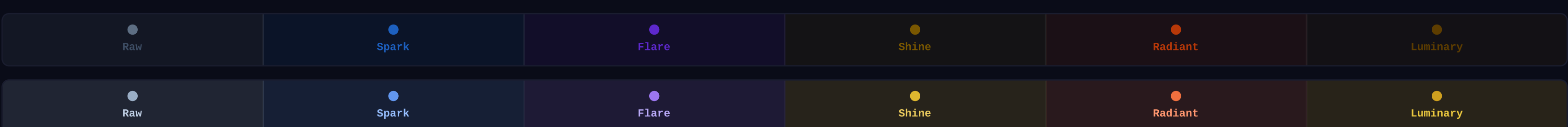
color: #5E3E00 · text: #5E3E00 · 9.2:1 ✓

DARK MODE

● LUM Luminary

color: #D0A020 · text: #ECC840 · 8.6:1 ✓

VISUAL PROGRESSION CHECK — BOTH MODES



6 · SEMANTIC TOKEN MAPPINGS

Background, text, border, interactive

These are the tokens components will reference directly. All marked CORE. Contrast ratios shown for text tokens; bg tokens show the text placed on them.

BACKGROUND TOKENS

TOKEN	LIGHT	DARK	CONTRAST	USAGE
color/bg/page CORE	■ #F0EFED	■ #0A0A09	—	Main page ground
color/bg/surface CORE	■ #FAF9F7	■ #131311	—	Card, panel
color/bg/elevated CORE	■ #FFFFFF	■ #1D1D1A	—	Modal, tooltip, popover
color/bg/muted CORE	■ #E4E3DF	■ #1D1D1A	—	Disabled, placeholder fills
color/bg/subtle CORE	■ #EAEAE7	■ #252523	—	Hover tint, input bg

TEXT TOKENS — CONTRAST SHOWN VS. RESPECTIVE BG/PAGE

TOKEN	LIGHT	DARK	CONTRAST	USAGE
color/text/primary CORE	■ #0E0D0B	■ #E7E7E3	17.3:1 16.8:1	Body copy, headings
color/text/secondary CORE	■ #484744	■ #BBB7B2	8.9:1 10.4:1	Supporting labels
color/text/muted CORE	■ #636260	■ #8A8A84	5.3:1 6.5:1	Captions, timestamps — body-safe ✓
color/text/subtle CORE	■ #7A7975	■ #6B6862	3.83:1 3.4:1	Large text / decorative only — NOT body text
color/text/disabled CORE	■ #AEADA8	■ #4E4D48	2.0:1 2.2:1	Disabled state — decorative, no content
color/text/on-primary CORE	■ #FFFFFF	■ #0A0A09	5.1:1 5.0:1	Text on primary button
color/text/on-accent CORE	■ #FFFFFF	■ #0A0A09	6.4:1 4.7:1	Text on accent bg
color/text/on-verified CORE	■ #FFFFFF	■ #0A0A09	6.25:1 9.1:1	Text on verified bg (dark mode uses #10C4B8)

BORDER TOKENS

TOKEN	LIGHT	DARK	CONTRAST	USAGE
color/border/default CORE	■ #CECDCA	■ #2A2A26	—	Card edges, dividers — hairline
color/border/strong CORE	■ #AEADA8	■ #3A3A35	—	Focus rings, emphasis borders
color/border/muted CORE	■ #DDDCD8	■ #232320	—	Subtle section dividers

INTERACTIVE TOKENS

TOKEN	LIGHT	DARK	CONTRAST	USAGE
color/interactive/primary/default CORE	■ #C03910	■ #E04020	—	Primary button fill
color/interactive/primary/hover CORE	■ #9E2E08	■ #EC5430	—	Primary button hover
color/interactive/primary/active CORE	■ #7A2204	■ #C03910	—	Primary button pressed
color/interactive/primary/subtle CORE	■ #FFF2EE	■ #2E1408	—	Primary tinted surface
color/interactive/accent/default CORE	■ #0050C8	■ #2878E0	—	Accent button, link
color/interactive/accent/hover CORE	■ #003FA8	■ #4090F0	—	Accent hover
color/interactive/accent/subtle CORE	■ #EBF2FF	■ #981830	—	Accent tinted surface
color/interactive/focus-ring CORE	■ #C03910	■ #E04020	—	2px offset ring — matches primary